FOR HEALTHCARE PROFESSIONALS

Reading an OUCH report

What it is, how to read it, what it does not say.

One page
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WHAT IT IS

OUCH is a free, open-source pain diary for fibromyalgia and other chronic pain. The patient logs their day in under a minute on their phone, with no account; their data stays on the device. This document is the report they built from it for your appointment (PDF or printout).

WHAT IT IS FOR

Day-by-day figures rather than a recollection: pain since the last appointment, compared with the period before, the days clearly harder than usual, treatments with their reported effects, and what the patient wants to tell you. An aid for the history, not for decisions.

READING THE FIRST PAGE, IN ORDER

1. **The top banner**
The period covered (since the last appointment of the same kind), the earlier period it is compared with, and the share of days logged. Missing days are never filled in.

2. **The key figures and their arrow**
The arrow only gives the direction of change since the earlier period: ▼ green, the favourable direction for that figure; ▲ orange, the opposite; — grey dash, a change too small to count. It gives neither the size nor whether the gap exceeds usual variation: see “Key points”.

3. **The curve**
Dots: each day’s pain. Line: 7-day rolling mean. Shaded bands: “harder” days (flares). Dashes: severe pain threshold (7).

4. **Flares**
OUCH’s own definition, with no consensus: at least 3 days in a row with pain at least 2 points (or 30%) above the patient’s usual level, peaking at 4/10 or more. Periods the patient marks themselves are counted separately.

5. **“Key points”**
A few figures in sentences: mean and median, comparison, the 30% change usually taken as clinically relevant[1][2], severe days, flares, treatment changes and reported effects.

6. **What the patient added**
Their questions, their note, their hard periods and the leads they kept: in their words, not measured. These are comparisons between days, never causes.

TWO VERSIONS

Family doctor · 2 to 4 pages
Key figures, curve, breakdown of days, key points, treatments, what the patient wants to raise.

Pain clinic · 5 to 9 pages
Adds detailed statistics, flares and the 3 days before each, each symptom, painkillers week by week, associated factors.

Keep in mind. OUCH describes: it makes no diagnosis, advises no treatment and never presents an association as a cause. Self-reported data, not verified. Fatigue, sleep, mood and per-condition indicator scales are not validated. The report is built on the phone; the name is not stored, the date of birth stays on the device. References [1][2] are those of the methodology note.

GOING FURTHER

The leaflet (2 pages) and the methodology note (12 pages: every formula, threshold and source) are on the project’s latest release page. The app is open to all, with a demo mode of 90 made-up days: **maxauvy.github.io/OUCH**. Your feedback is welcome.

Free software, CeCILL v2.1 licence